

I Really Want to Google This / I Need to Know

If you're feeling this urge to look something up or check into something or ask someone, a doctor, a friend, the internet, Reddit, if this is okay, if this is normal, if you're going to be fine, I know how strong that urge is because there's this belief that if I could just get the right answer, the right reassurance, like if I could just hear the right thing, then I would get relief from this nightmare.

I'd finally be able to relax. But you know by now that that doesn't work that way. And every single time you give into this urge, you get that tiny hit of relief, and then it wears off within one minute to two hours, and then the next time you need more, just another link, another person, another dm, that the checking never satisfies you.

And it never will. The reassurance is not going to stick this time, it never has in the past. We wanna be careful in this moment not to reinforce to the nervous system that you're in danger. We don't want it to keep learning that you can't handle uncertainty. That's the real issue here. It's not that you need more information, it's that your system has just been trained over time to interpret not knowing something for certain as a dangerous thing.

And so every time you reach for certainty, you reinforce that. So here's the work. You don't Google. You don't check, you don't ask. You do not research. You use this moment to practice sitting with not knowing. Let the question stay open in your brain. Let the loop stay open you. You have to tolerate the discomfort of uncertainty without getting the payoff of closing the loop.

This builds so much resilience and you're in one of those moments right now. One of the only times you get to practice staying in an open loop is when you are stuck in that open loop. I'm not saying you can never go to a doctor or ask a question, but if you're doing it from that urgent, desperate place, that place that says, I need to know right now or I cannot function, that is not seeking information.

That's that's a compulsive need for reassurance and feeding it. It just makes it stronger. If you need a reminder of how this pattern keeps the alarm running, revisit

lesson two. You already have enough information. The work here is to stop reaching for more.